OPEN LETTER · EYE ON SHOALHAVEN COUNCIL

Letter to Cr Luciano Casmiri: which homes have his housing motions delivered?

Sent 4 November 2026 · To Shoalhaven City Council · Response requested by 25 November 2026

Eye on Shoalhaven Council
steveprothero.substack.com

4 November 2026

Cr Luciano Casmiri
Shoalhaven City Council

Dear Cr Casmiri,

Request for evidence of housing delivery, and right of reply

I am preparing an article for Eye on Shoalhaven Council on your housing record, prompted by your Facebook post on the Shoalhaven Housing Strategy. This letter is journalism. You may choose not to answer, but I would like to publish your response and am giving you the opportunity to give it.

What the article says

In summary, the draft article reports the following, each of which I invite you to correct:

1. The Strategy paragraph in your post closely follows the Background section of the staff report on CL26.287. On 27 October you moved the staff recommendation as it stood (MIN26.414), and it carried 12 to 1. The discussion paper says the Strategy will not directly change planning controls.
2. In 2025 and 2026 your housing motions mostly reduced costs or process for builders: the DCP changes on parking and landscaping (MIN26.415), the Ulladulla rezoning, and the rescission of the East Street call-in. Council's own risk statement on the DCP changes says they may not lead to more affordable or diverse housing.
3. I found no motion you moved that targets first-home buyers, and none that requires a cost saving to be passed on to a buyer or tenant.
4. The State target is about 980 homes a year. Council's paper reports approvals averaging 710 a year over 2024 to 2026 and a forecast need of 529, and says the target significantly exceeds recent delivery trends.
5. The one recent project that delivered affordable homes, Coomea Street, Bomaderry (39 homes), was resolved in June 2020. I have found no documented role for you in it.

Questions

1. Which homes have been built, approved or secured as a result of a motion you moved or seconded? Please give the resolution number, the address or project, and the number and type of homes.

2. What dollar saving per home do you expect from the parking and landscape changes in MIN26.415, and what in the resolution ensures it reaches a buyer or tenant rather than the developer?
3. What evidence do you rely on that lower design standards reduce prices in Shoalhaven?
4. Will you move that any concession to developers be conditional on a lower price or capped rent for the buyer or tenant? If not, why not?
5. If the 4,900-home target is the measure of success in your post, what do you say about Council's own statement that the target significantly exceeds recent delivery?
6. Is there anything in the five points above that you say is wrong? If so, please identify it and the document that shows it.
Timing
Any reply you send will be summarised accurately or quoted in full, and I will correct any factual error you identify with evidence.

I am not making any finding about your motives. The article is about what the record shows.

Yours sincerely,

Stephen Prothero
Eye on Shoalhaven Council
